



THE EGYPTIAN • WESTERN DESERT

06

The White Desert Exploration Trek

Twelve days on foot along the old Baharia–Farafra camel route

A journey you can picture yourself inside

Twelve days walking the caravan route that linked Baharia to Farafra long before the British laid a track beside it. Every night in a tent. The walk works through four dune systems, a hidden desert garden, two Roman wells, two labyrinths and both White Deserts before turning for the road.

The sixth of nine and the longer of the two walking tours. It covers everything in the seven-day trek and adds the Rajeh dunes, the Pac Man Hills, the desert garden and the El Matar labyrinth.

THE NINE, BY LENGTH IN DAYS

01	02	03	04	05	06	07	08	09
3	4	4	5	7	12	12	15	20

SHORTEST

EACH IS BOOKED ON ITS OWN

DEEPEST

HOW YOU TRAVEL

On foot · Camping. Cairo return · 12 days · Groups of 8 to 20. Each of the nine journeys is a separate booking with its own start and finish; none is a stage of another.

IMPORTANT

This is the intended route, not a fixed timetable.

It communicates the ground covered, the pace and the level of effort. Named properties, exact camp locations, departure times, prices and meal inclusions are confirmed at booking. Weather, park authorities, soft sand and vehicle recovery can change the order or content of a day; this guide names those dependencies wherever they affect your choice.

Every day carries the same four facts

ROUTE

Where the day starts, what it passes through and where it ends.

SLEEP

Tent or bed, and where. Camps are chosen on the day; the area is fixed, the exact spot is not.

DISTANCE

Kilometres where the source gives them, on foot for the walking tours, otherwise an estimate.

MEALS

What is included that day. Anything not listed is not included.

RHYTHM

A reading of how much the day asks of you, followed by the kind of ground it crosses.

 Easy

Road transfer, an oasis day, or a short walk. Recoverable.

 Steady

A full day of driving or walking, with stops. The normal shape.

 Demanding

Long hours, soft sand, recovery work or a hard walk. Plan around it.

FREE TIME

Noted where a day holds unstructured hours. Desert days rarely do; the group moves together and the camp is made together.

The White Desert Exploration Trek

NIGHTS CAMPING 11 · every night

NIGHTS IN LODGES None

DAILY DISTANCE ON FOOT 15–20 km

GROUND COVERED Dr's Hill · Rajeh · Agabat · Karaween · Pac Man Hills · Ein El Serw · El Matar · both Wadis · Ein Khadra · Old and New White Desert

HOW THE DAYS GROUP

Crystal Mountain to the dunes Days 1–3

Karaween and the Pac Man Hills Days 4–6

The wells and the valleys Days 7–9

Old and New White Desert Days 10–12

01

Cairo — Baharia — Dr's Hill

ROUTE	SLEEP	DISTANCE	MEALS
Cairo → Baharia Oasis → Crystal Mountain → sand and hill labyrinth → Dr's Hill	Camp · Dr's Hill	≈12 km on foot	Lunch, dinner

■ STEADY · TREK

A 0700 pickup and the drive west, with lunch in the oasis. The first trek runs about twelve kilometres from Crystal Mountain into a labyrinth of sand and low hills, ending at Dr's Hill with its serene sand patches. Dinner around the fire under the stars.

02

Dr's Hill — Rajeh Dunes

ROUTE	SLEEP	DISTANCE	MEALS
Dr's Hill → old Baharia-Farafra camel route → Rajeh Sand Dunes	Camp · Rajeh Dunes	15-20 km on foot	Breakfast, lunch, dinner

■ STEADY · TREK

The walk follows the camel caravan route that linked Baharia and Farafra for thousands of years, with a scheduled lunch stop along it, and finishes on the Rajeh sand dunes.

03 Rajeh Dunes — Agabat

ROUTE	SLEEP	DISTANCE	MEALS
Rajeh Dunes → dune crossings → Agabat Labyrinth	Camp · Agabat	15-20 km on foot	Breakfast, lunch, dinner

DEMANDING · TREK

Criss-crossing a series of dunes to the lunch stop, then a descent into the Agabat labyrinth with its giant white chalk hills. Camp is set on the sand patches among the formations.

NOTE	Have a jacket at hand in the early hours; sunrise is cold and worth being up for.
------	---

04 Agabat — Karaween Dunes

ROUTE	SLEEP	DISTANCE	MEALS
Agabat Labyrinth → Tamarisk tree → Karaween Dunes	Camp · Karaween Dunes	15-20 km on foot	Breakfast, lunch, dinner

STEADY · TREK

First light on the chalk around the camp is a bewildering thing. The trek works through the labyrinth past a lone tamarisk, then into the Karaween dunes, where crescents, domes and parallel seif dunes appear in turn.

05

Karaween Dunes — Pac Man Hills

ROUTE	SLEEP	DISTANCE	MEALS
Karaween Dunes → Pac Man Hills → the desert garden	Camp · near the desert garden	15-20 km on foot	Breakfast, lunch, dinner

■ STEADY · TREK

Out of the dunes into a labyrinth of flat-topped hills, then on to a hidden garden of palm, tamarisk and acacia holding flora and fauna rarely seen in the region. Camp sits a short distance away so the area can be explored on foot.

06

Pac Man Hills — Karaween Dunes

ROUTE	SLEEP	DISTANCE	MEALS
Pac Man Hills → Karaween Sand Dunes	Camp · Karaween Dunes	15-20 km on foot	Breakfast, lunch, dinner

■ STEADY · TREK

Back through the Pac Man Hills with a lunch stop on route, then into the Karaween sand dunes for the night.

07

Karaween — El Serw Well — Al Wadi Al Sagheer

ROUTE	SLEEP	DISTANCE	MEALS
Karaween Dunes → Ein El Serw (Roman well) → Al Wadi Al Sagheer	Camp · Al Wadi Al Sagheer	15-20 km on foot	Breakfast, lunch, dinner

■ STEADY · TREK

The dunes give way to the Roman well at Ein El Serw — lunch, and a well-earned wash after seven days of desert travel. The walk continues into the small valley, which two thousand years ago was green enough to hold a settlement.

NOTE	The first proper wash of the trek.
------	------------------------------------

08

Al Wadi Al Sagheer — El Matar Labyrinth

ROUTE	SLEEP	DISTANCE	MEALS
Al Wadi Al Sagheer → escarpments → El Matar Labyrinth	Camp · El Matar	15-20 km on foot	Breakfast, lunch, dinner

■ STEADY · TREK

Through the valley and along a series of escarpments, with the ground changing continuously underfoot, to the white hill labyrinth of El Matar.

09

El Matar — Al Wadi Al Kabeer

ROUTE	SLEEP	DISTANCE	MEALS
El Matar → Al Wadi Al Kabeer	Camp · Al Wadi Al Kabeer	15-20 km on foot	Breakfast, lunch, dinner

■ **STEADY · TREK**

The bigger valley takes the walk to lower ground that was a green oasis two thousand years ago; the signs of the vegetation are still readable. Dinner around the fire.

10

Al Wadi Al Kabeer — Ein Khadra — Old White Desert

ROUTE	SLEEP	DISTANCE	MEALS
Al Wadi Al Kabeer → escarpment → Ein Khadra → El Santa → Old White Desert	Camp · Old White Desert	15-20 km on foot	Breakfast, lunch, dinner

■ **DEMANDING · TREK**

Up onto the escarpment to the second Roman well at Ein Khadra, then a hike to El Santa, the 2,000-year-old acacia, for lunch. The afternoon enters the Old White Desert and its endless chalk.

11 Old White Desert — New White Desert

ROUTE	SLEEP	DISTANCE	MEALS
Old White Desert → New White Desert	Camp · New White Desert	≈12 km on foot	Breakfast, lunch, dinner

■ STEADY · TREK

A morning touring the older formations, where the chalk carries the signs of an ecosystem that lived under the sea millions of years ago. A short trek after lunch reaches the New White Desert.

12 New White Desert — Baharia — Cairo

ROUTE	SLEEP	DISTANCE	MEALS
New White Desert → vehicle meeting point → hot well → Baharia Oasis → Cairo	—	Short hike, then ≈370 km road	Breakfast, lunch

■ EASY · RETURN

The last sunrise and a final morning walk, then the hike out to the vehicles, a dip at a hot well, lunch in Baharia and the drive to Cairo.

What the price carries, and what it does not

INCLUDED
Assembly pickup and drop-off at an agreed Cairo location — 700+ km round trip
Transport to and from the desert start and finish points
All meals listed in the itinerary
Drinks, snacks and fruit — water, tea, coffee, mint
Desert gear: kitchen, camping and recovery equipment
Tents, sleeping mats, sleeping bags and blankets
A friendly, English-speaking, experienced guide and a cook for the journey

NOT INCLUDED
White Desert National Park tickets
Personal expenses
Travel and medical insurance
Alcoholic beverages
Tips and gratuities

RATES

Priced on enquiry.

The source itinerary publishes no rate card. Every one of these journeys is quoted against the group — its size, its dates and any tailoring — so the figure is set on enquiry. This panel is reserved for the rate line and the deposit terms once you supply them.

Where this journey asks more of you

Twelve days of 15 to 20 km on foot, over dunes, chalk and gravel. Physical endurance is a requirement, not a preference.

Eleven consecutive nights in tents. The only wash of the trek is at the Roman well on day seven, and the hot well on the last day.

Vehicles carry the camp and meet the group at the desert start and finish points only.

Groups of 8 to 20. Active November to April; the nights are cold throughout.

SEASON

Active November to April. Outside that window the heat makes the deep desert unworkable.

PHYSICAL DEMAND

15 to 20 km on foot per day across sand, gravel and chalk. Real endurance is required.

GROUP

Groups of 8 to 20. Departures are private to the group.

VEHICLES AND GEAR

Toyota Landcruisers, stocked with supplies, kitchen, camping and recovery gear. Tents, mats, sleeping bags and blankets are provided.

TAILORING

This journey can be tailored for a specific number of travellers, and the day order can be adjusted around your dates. Contact us for an offer.

From this guide to a confirmed departure

01

Tell us the shape of the group

Numbers, dates in the November-to-April window, and anything the itinerary should bend around — age, mobility, diet, or a date that matters.

02

Receive the offer

A quoted price against that group, with the lodges named, the vehicles counted and the inclusions fixed against this itinerary.

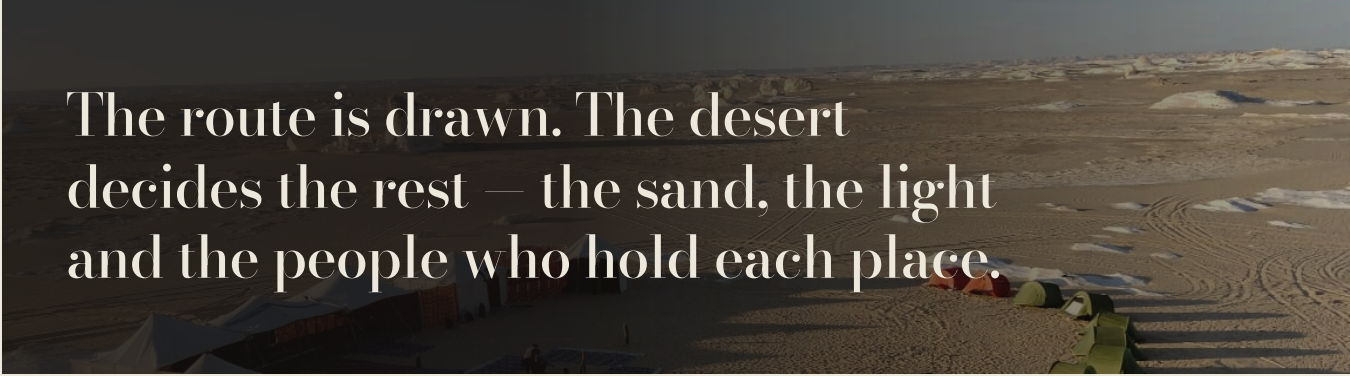
03

Confirm and prepare

A kit list, park ticket costs, insurance requirements and the final day plan follow confirmation.

ENQUIRIES

This journey can be tailored for a specific number of travellers. Contact us for an offer against your own dates.



The route is drawn. The desert
decides the rest — the sand, the light
and the people who hold each place.